

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

THERE'S NOW A WORD FOR AI-FAKED LISTING PHOTOS.

Housefishing. And one state already made it illegal.

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**"YOU SHOULDN'T
HAVE TO WORRY
WHETHER THE
APARTMENT
YOU'RE VIEWING
ONLINE IS REAL."**

NYC Mayor Zohran Mamdani, announcing a
crackdown on AI-altered rental photos, July 2026.

BUYERS HAVE A NAME FOR IT. REGULATORS ARE CATCHING UP.

California's AB 723, effective this year, requires any digitally altered real estate photo to carry a disclosure and a link to the unedited original. New York City's mayor has proposed the same rule for rental listings, after "housefishing" spread as the word for repainted walls, invented lawns, and a listed "loft" that turned out to have no ladder, let alone a room. Even Zillow told Fortune it supports the disclosure and wants buyers able to see the original image next to the altered one. The direction is the same everywhere: label it, or don't run it.

THE SWAP, BEFORE YOUR NEXT LISTING GOES LIVE:

- 1 Never post a virtually staged or AI-edited photo without labeling it.**

One line, "virtually staged," costs nothing and stops the walkthrough from feeling like a bait and switch.
- 2 Keep the real, unedited photo on file, disclosed or not.**

California's law now requires a link to it. Where it isn't required yet, a buyer who asks should get it the same day.
- 3 Don't let AI remove anything a buyer will notice is gone.**

The utility pole, the busy street, the cracked driveway. Say so before the showing, not after.

THE TAKEAWAY

"HOUSEFISHING" HAS A NAME NOW.

Label the edit, keep the real photo, and it never has yours on it.